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(54) FITNESS DEVICE FOR LOWER BODY

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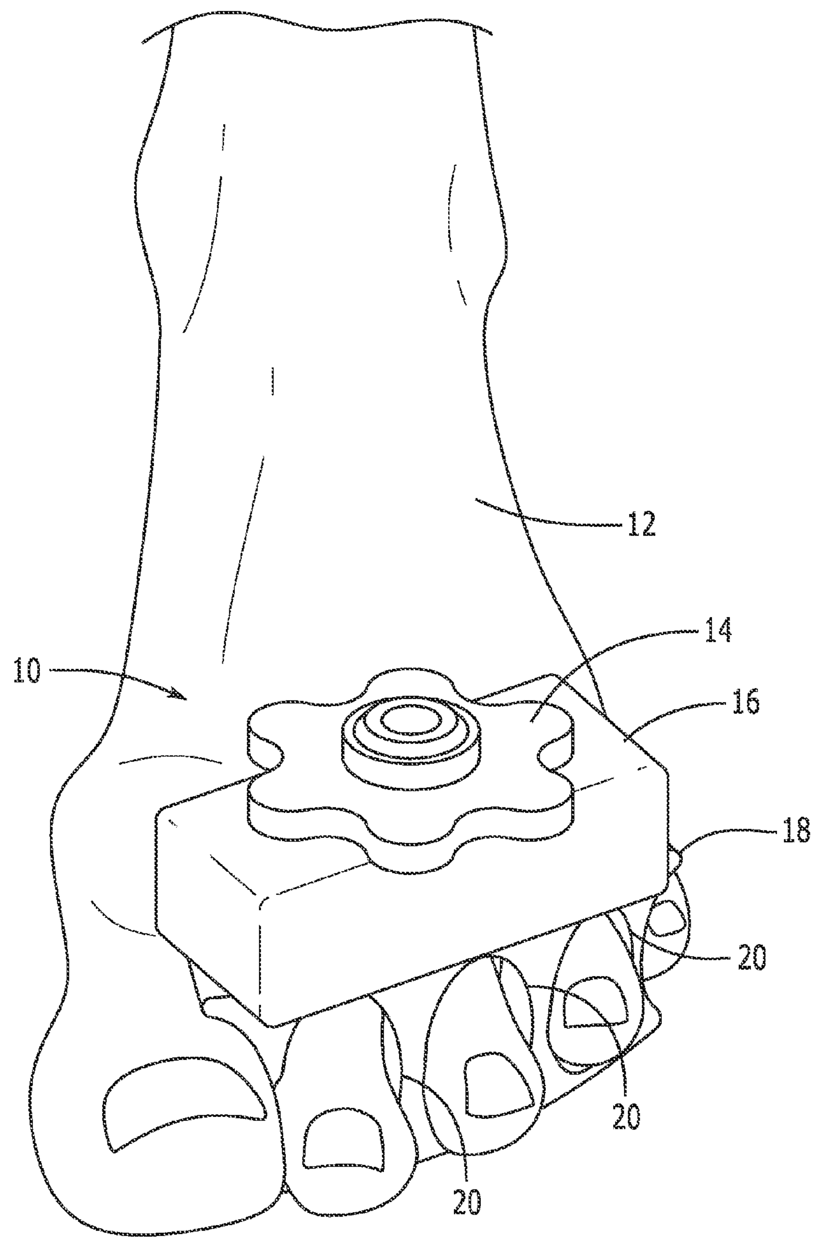
(57) **ABSTRACT**

An exercise device includes a body with through holes for inserting a user's toes, a partially threaded rod, and a dowel; a weight mounted on the rod and dowel; and a threaded nut fastened to the rod. An exercise method includes gripping the device with a user's toes and actuating a joint on the leg with the device installed. The method exercises the user's lower body, including the fine musculature of the feet and toes.



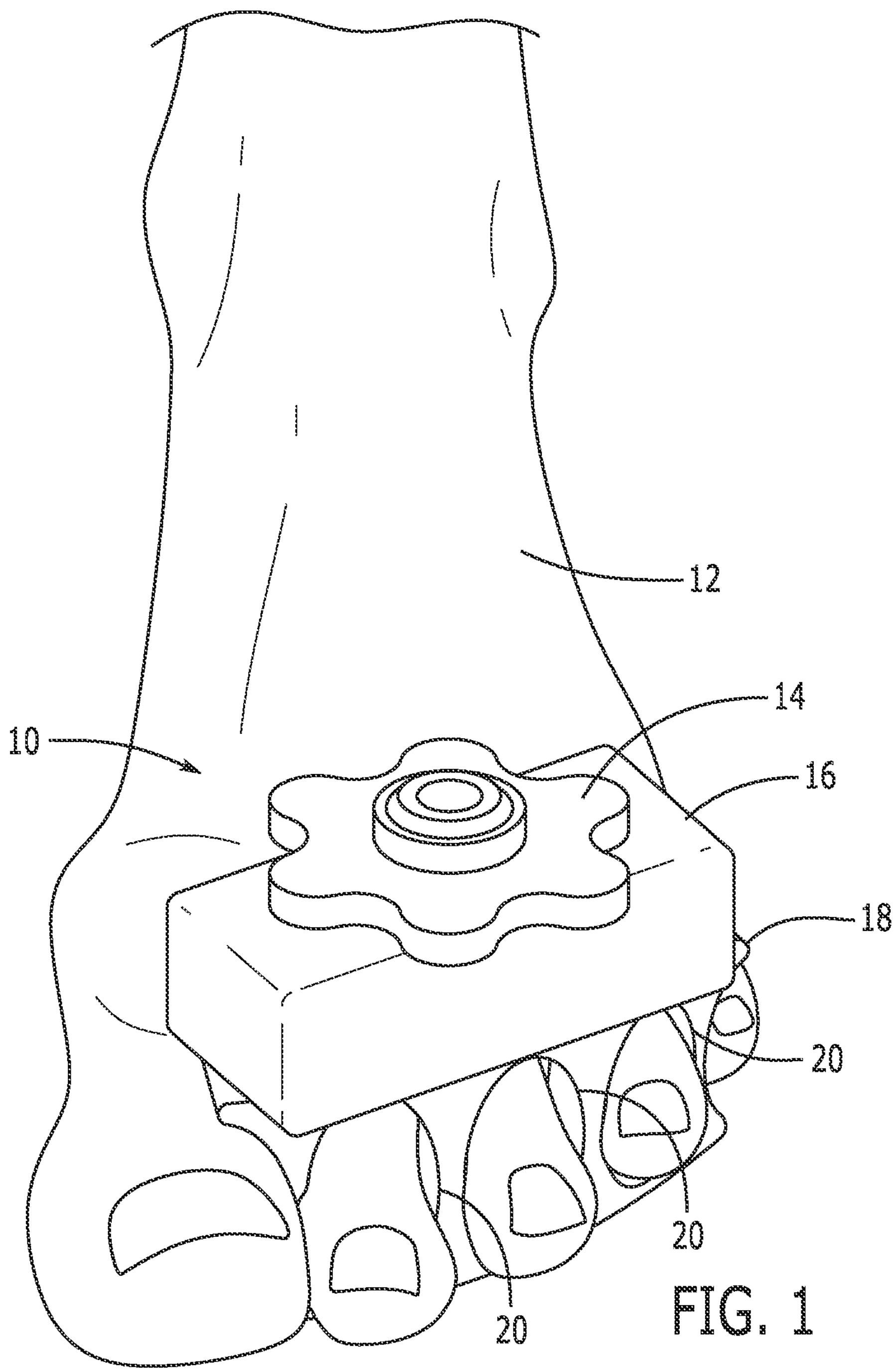


FIG. 1

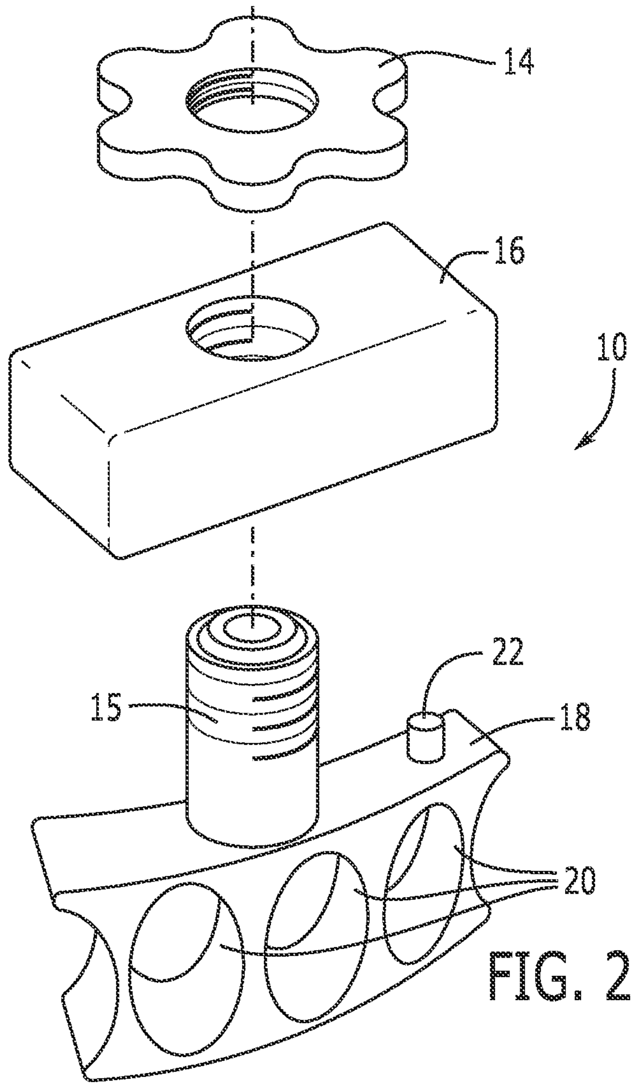


FIG. 2

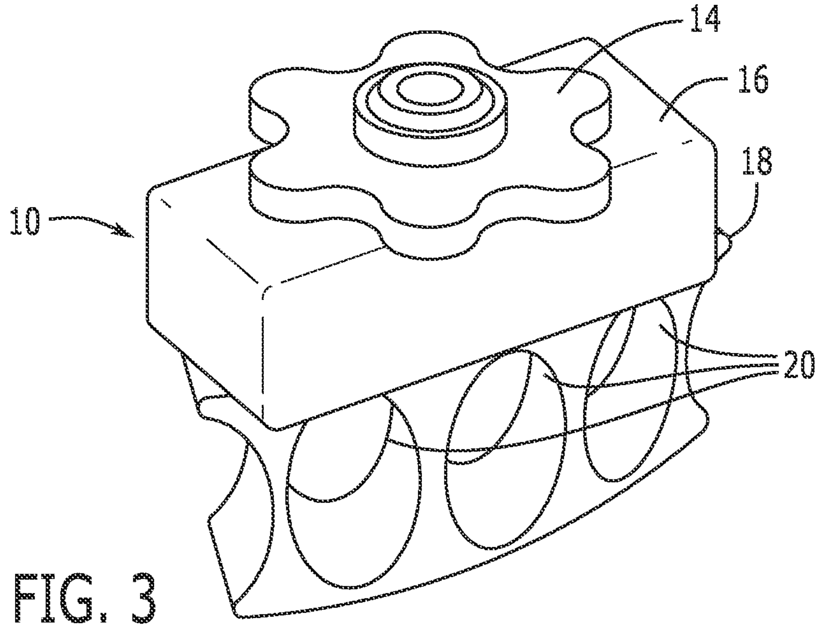


FIG. 3

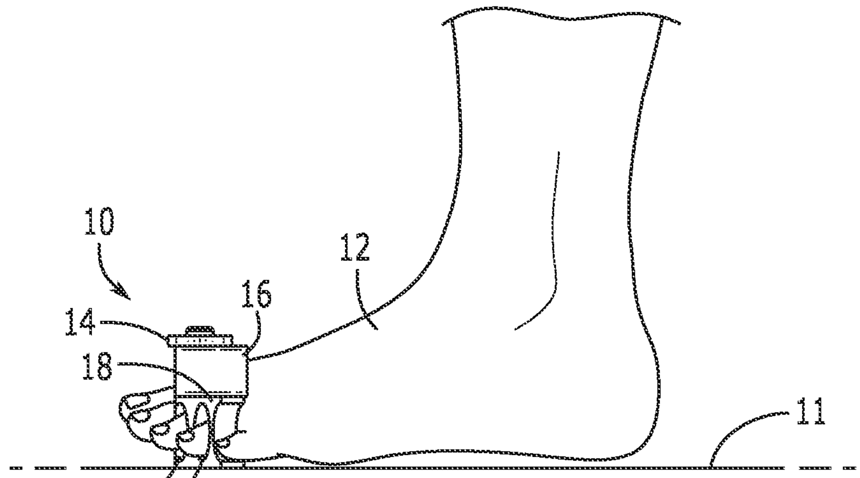


FIG. 4

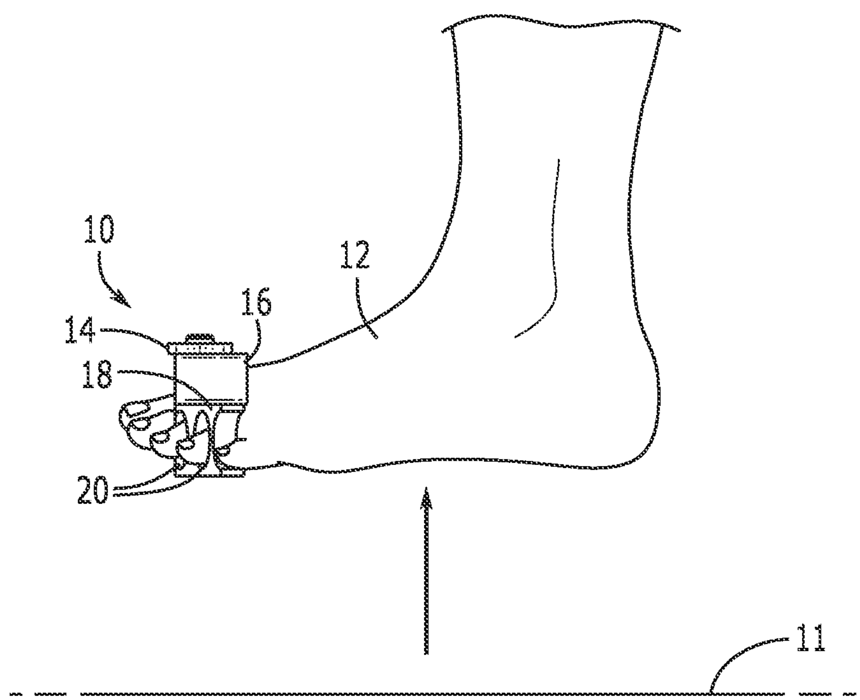


FIG. 5

FITNESS DEVICE FOR LOWER BODY

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

[0001] The present invention relates to exercise devices and, more particularly, to a device for fitness, mobility and rehabilitation of lower body extremities including legs, ankles, feet and toes.

[0002] Existing devices for exercising the lower body include large gym equipment such as leg press machines, squat racks, ankle weights, leg curl/extension machines and calf raise machines. These existing machines are costly, require additional space and do not provide a mechanism for exercising the fine musculature of a foot and toes. However, there exists no system for training the fine musculature associated with the toes and feet.

[0003] As can be seen, there is a need for a device that can exercise the fine musculature associated with the toes and feet.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0004] In one aspect of the present invention, an exercise device for the lower body is provided. The exercise device includes a rectangular prism shaped body that has a plurality of through holes adapted to accept a user's toes. A threaded cylindrical rod extends from the body to accept a weight or weights. The body also includes a mechanism for preventing an inserted weight from translating. The mechanism for preventing translation is a dowel affixed to the body and insertable into the weight, and a threaded nut is placed on the threaded rod to fix the weight in place.

[0005] These and other features, aspects and advantages of the present invention will become better understood with reference to the following drawings, description, and claims.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0006] FIG. **1** is a front top perspective view of an exercise device according to an embodiment of the present invention, shown in use;

[0007] FIG. **2** is a detail exploded perspective view thereof;

[0008] FIG. **3** is another front top perspective view thereof;

[0009] FIG. **4** is a side elevation view thereof, shown in a first position; and

[0010] FIG. **5** is another side elevation view thereof, shown in a second position.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

[0011] The following detailed description is of the best currently contemplated modes of carrying out exemplary embodiments of the invention. The description is not to be taken in a limiting sense but is made merely for the purpose of illustrating the general principles of the invention, since the scope of the invention is best defined by the appended claims.

[0012] Broadly, one embodiment of the present invention is an exercise device configured for mounting on a user's toes for exercising the fine musculature of the user's feet and toes.

[0013] The exercise device may be used with a weighted block having any increment of weight sufficient to provide resistance to a user's toes, feet, ankle, or leg. The user may lift the device by articulation of a hip and knee, for example, or user could articulate one or more of the lower body joints to perform an exercise. For example, the user could articulate toe joints, ankle joints, knee joints and/or hip joints, individually or in combination.

[0014] Referring to FIGS. **1-5**, FIG. **1** illustrates an exercise device **10** according to an embodiment of the present invention, comprising a weight bearing body **18** with toe holes **20** formed therein. A weighted block **16** is shown attached to the body **18** and secured by a threaded nut **14**. The device **10** can be installed on the user's foot **12** by sliding the user's toes into the toe holes **20**.

[0015] As shown in FIG. **2**, a threaded rod **15** and a dowel rod **22** extend from the body **18** to secure the weight or weighted block **16**. The rod **15** extends from an upper surface of the body **18**, perpendicular to the toe holes **20**, and is threaded from an end distal to the body **18**. The weight **16** has a bore formed therethrough that may have a mated thread pattern. The dowel rod **22** extends from the upper surface of the body **18** proximal to an edge thereof to prevent translational motion of the weight **16**. The threaded rod **15** may also have a smooth (unthreaded) portion proximal to the body **18**, allowing the user to adjust the position of the weight **16** to insert the dowel rod **22**. Once the weight **16** is mounted to the body **18**, a threaded nut **14** can be fastened to the threaded portion of the rod **15**. FIG. **3** illustrates the assembled device **10** with the weight **16** fastened to the body **18** with the threaded nut **14**.

[0016] FIGS. **4-5** illustrate an exemplary exercise method utilizing the device **10**. Once a user's toes have been inserted through toe holes **20**, the device **10** may be gripped by the toes while the user articulates any joint in the lower body against the resistance of the weight **16**. FIG. **4** shows the device at rest on the floor while FIG. **5** shows the lower body extremity lifted off the ground **11**.

[0017] It should be understood, of course, that the foregoing relates to exemplary embodiments of the invention and that modifications may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention as set forth in the following claims.

What is claimed is:

1. An exercise device, comprising:

a body having a plurality of through holes formed therein, a threaded rod extending from the body, perpendicular to the plurality of through holes, and a dowel extending from the body parallel to the threaded rod, wherein the body, the threaded rod, and the dowel are monolithically formed; and

a threaded nut, threadedly mated to the threaded rod.

2. The exercise device of claim **1**, wherein the body has a substantially rectangular prismatic configuration.

3. The exercise device of claim **1**, wherein the threaded rod further comprises a non-threaded portion proximal to the body.

4. The exercise device of claim **1**, further comprising:

a weight having a bore therethrough configured to accommodate the threaded rod.

5. The exercise device of claim **4**, wherein the weight has a recess formed therein operative to accommodate the dowel.

6. A method of exercise, comprising:

gripping the exercise device of claim **1** with at least one toe; and performing a movement engaging at least one joint selected from the group consisting of: a toe joint, an ankle joint, a knee joint, a hip joint, and any combination thereof.

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